



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Mauritania. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that—you're in an exciting place in life, and thinking ahead like this is a great start. Since you've just finished primary school (folkeskole) in Denmark and you're fluent in Danish, you have several good options depending on your interests, strengths, and goals. I'll walk you through your main options and offer guidance to help you decide.

Your Main Options After Folkeskole

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

This is the academic route, typically lasting 3 years. It prepares you for university or other higher education.

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – Focus on general academic subjects like languages, humanities, sciences. Good if you want broad options for university later.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)** – Focuses on business, economics, marketing, and languages. Great if you're interested in business or international trade.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination)** – Focus on science, technology, and innovation. Ideal if you like tech, engineering, or natural sciences.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)** – A shorter (2-year) program, more flexible and often taken by older students, but open to young people too.

Choose this path if:

- You enjoy academic work and want to go to university.
- You're not 100% sure yet, but want to keep your future options open.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD)

This is a more hands-on, job-oriented path. You split time between school and apprenticeship in a company.

Examples:

- Electrician, carpenter, mechanic
- Hairdresser, chef, child care assistant
- IT supporter, data technician

Choose this path if:

- You prefer practical, hands-on work.
- You want to get into a job more quickly.
- You already know what trade or field you want to work in.

3. Kombinerede eller fleksible forløb

If you're not quite sure what you want, there are flexible intro programs like:

- **FGU (Forberedende Grunduddannelse)** – For those who need extra time or support to get ready for vocational education or a job.
- **EUX** – A hybrid program that combines vocational training with general academic subjects. You can become e.g. a carpenter **and** qualify for university later.

✓ Choose this path if:

- You want the best of both worlds (hands-on work + academic access).
- You're still exploring but want to stay productive.

Other Personal Factors to Consider

- **What are you passionate about?** (e.g., science, business, tech, helping people?)
- **Do you want to go to university later or start working sooner?**
- **Do you enjoy classroom learning or hands-on experience more?**
- **Do you want to support your family or community in specific ways (e.g. in healthcare, education, law)?**

My Recommendation (Based on What You've Said)

Since you're fluent in Danish, were born and raised in Denmark, and just finished primary school, you probably have a solid academic base. Unless you already know you want to do something specific (like becoming an electrician or chef), I would recommend starting with **STX, HHX, or HTX**, depending on your interests:

-  **STX** if you like languages, social studies, or science and want to keep your future open.
-  **HHX** if you're interested in business, marketing, or economics.
-  **HTX** if you're into science, tech, or engineering.

You can always switch later if it's not the right fit. Also, remember: success doesn't depend on doing things "the normal way." Many paths can lead to a good life in Denmark.

Would you like help narrowing it down based on your interests or strengths?